

Euro
Bureau
for
Self~
Publishers



Contents *for* Self-Publishers

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EuroBureau *for* Self-Publishers

EuroBureau is an online collaborative office suite (in fact, just word processing and spreadsheets) that serves as an alternative to megalithic platforms like Google Docs and Office.

Online word processing is enormously handy for the self-publishing author and just having an alternative that doesn't train an AI engine on our work is enough of a reason to switch, in my view, but EuroBureau offers scores of stores of other advantages that could be called, in aggregate, integrated self-publishing.

Self-published authors are like snowflakes in that we're all unique and, in our numbers, we present a hazard to safe driving. There are some commonalities, though, to greater or lesser degrees, that inform the development of EuroBureau, to greater or lesser degrees:

- We tend to do our own formatting. This applies to ebooks and print.
- Many of us prefer writing to formatting, in much the same way and to the same degree that farmers prefer farming to, say, doing their taxes.
- We sometimes struggle with the technical aspects of generating POD-ready PDFs and platform-appropriate epub.
- We have cause to keep our files current, updating often for corrections or fresh backmatter, with frequent deployment to multiple platforms.
- We're neurotic about losing our work.
- There are some of us who have mixed feelings about voracious AI engines strip-mining our files to enrich billionaires.

One of the biggest time sinks inseparable from book layout is maintaining different files for different media formats.

Self-published authors currently using Google Docs or Office 365 will almost all follow a process something like this: finish the book, export it to some universal format, open it in Word or LibreOffice or similar desktop word processor, export it from there as an epub, format it for a particular paperback size, and then export that as a PDF, and almost always from then on maintain these three separate files during the inevitable fixes and changes that follow or, in the case of edition-level changes, start the process all over. Often one or more of these steps will be delegated to a designer or millennial.

This guide takes as a *first principle* the rule of **ONE** single **SOURCE** for editing, epub, and paperback.

One of the enormous advantages of digital publishing and print-on-demand paper publishing is the ability to quickly modify your book. When you find a mistake or need to change your back matter or, why not, you just feel like changing your back matter, you can do so and generate new files and upload them.

But if this means modifying and verifying multiple files then the bother and chances of error multiplies by, roughly, multiples, and your ability and, possibly, even your will to rapidly make changes is accordingly diminished.

When I used Google Docs I had a number of post-processing tools and scripts and practices that allowed me to regenerate everything from the same document every time I changed the back matter or found a typo, and I did both of those things rather a lot.

Google Docs' epub export is, speaking euphemistically, flawed. After exporting my epub I would open it as a zip and embed the fonts and remove the extra spaces and optimise the HTML for file size, if nothing else, and I'd undo much of the extra formatting I'd done to make the Google Docs version usable for paperback, though without hyphenation, kerning, and fine adjustments to prevent widows and orphans. Even then I had to apply a third-party utility to the PDF to add interior gutters.

EuroBureau has all that, in tenths of degrees. I can entirely lay out my paperback as a EuroBureau document in a page size that corresponds to that which I've selected on KDP, Ingram Spark, and BookVault, including mirrored gutters. I can kern a word or line or add a soft return if necessary to save an orphan or house a widow. I can have drop caps, include a QR code for newsletter signups in my backmatter, and export a perfect, point-for-point reproduction of my layout to PDF.

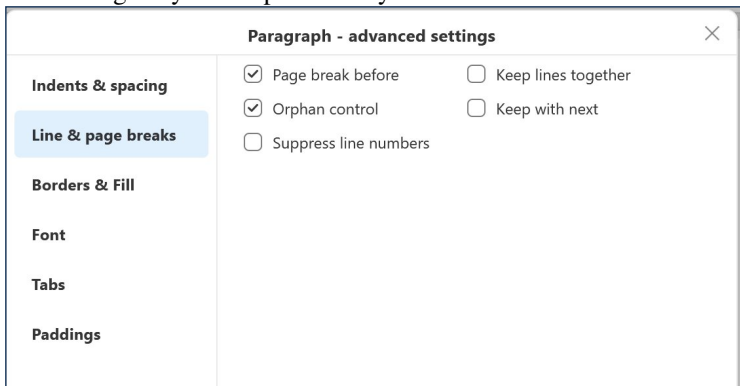
Obviously, epub doesn't support kerning or dropcaps and it's coldly indifferent to widows and orphans, so when EuroBureau exports to epub it leaves all those tiny adjustments behind and focuses instead on generating a file that passes all integrity tests.

EuroBureau's *self-publishing* features...

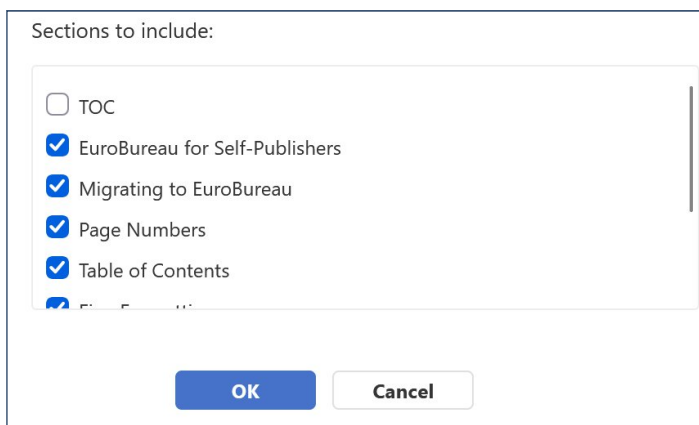
...in point form

- **Above all**, full word processing capabilities near to those offered by Microsoft Word or Libre Office in an online, collaborative, secure, AI-free, integrated platform.
- **Character spacing**
 - Sometimes, when there's no other way of saving an orphan, the last resort is to squeeze the space between the letters to bring that single word back up one line.
 - EuroBureau supports character spacing but note that at this writing the minimum squeeze is -.01 inches, which is very squeezey indeed. It's recommended that until this is a finer measure you use soft returns to save your orphans and house your widows.
 - As with soft returns, if it's not obvious, character-squeezing doesn't export to epub.
- **Embedded fonts**
 - Obviously fonts have to be embedded in PDFs for print-on-demand and EuroBureau handles this for you.
 - Few ereaders, however, support custom fonts.
 - On the other hand, some do. So do some previewers. EuroBureau will optionally include custom fonts when you export to epub.
 - Choosing to include the fonts will marginally increase the size of your epub archive, but that's all. Ereaders that don't support custom fonts will default to the nearest 'generic' (serif, sans-serif, cursive, etc.)
- **Font management**
 - There are loads of curated fonts in EuroBureau, specially selected for readability, along with many script and display faces, specially selected for illegibility.
 - If the font you need isn't there, though, you can nominate it for inclusion in the next release (which will happen the moment the font is acquired).
- **Gutters**
 - When laying out a book for print, you need to add an inside gutter — extra margin space near the fold (so, on the right on left-facing pages and on the left on right-facing pages) so no text is swallowed by the binding.

- EuroBureau provides this with the mirror-margin option in the margins settings.
- **Hyphenation**
 - Unlike some online word processors, EuroBureau has desktop-quality hyphenation which persists to PDF export but not, obviously, to epub.
- **Page Breaks**
 - Page breaks make most sense when laying out a paper book and a good deal less sense with ebooks, so EuroBureau strips them out when exporting to epub.
 - If you want a page break before, for example, a chapter heading (you do) then you should use the Page break before checkbox in the advanced settings of your paragraph and, perhaps obviously, make that the setting for your chapter title style.

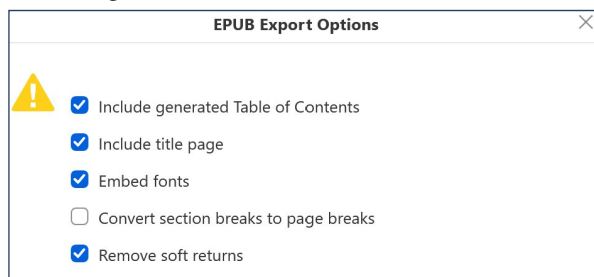


- **Selected sections** exported to epub
 - It's frequently a good idea to have different content in the paperback that doesn't need to be in the epub – the most obvious example is a table of contents pointing to specific pages or, for that matter, a table of contents. Few ereader readers will look at a traditional TOC at the beginning of the book, preferring instead the dynamic navigation offered by the device.
 - EuroBureau offers you the option of deselecting sections when exporting to epub so you can remove the TOC, blank pages, maybe a bar code, anything else you might want in the paper edition but not the epub.



- **Soft returns**

- It's often very handy when laying out a paperback to fold a chapter title or wrap a line to save an orphan.
- It's also often nice to balance out a two-line chapter title for the print version.
- Soft returns work properly in EuroBureau, which is to say that they behave as in-paragraph line-wraps, maintaining justification and spacing.
- What we don't need is soft returns in our epub. We don't want to tell the ereader how to wrap titles and orphans obviously aren't our concern, so EuroBureau offers you the option, when exporting to epub, of removing them.



- **Versioning and backups**

- Under the Collaboration tab (where, by the way, you can give another user permission to edit, made comments, or just read your document) you'll also find Version History. Clicking this will show you the last ten versions automatically backed up when you've made a reasonable number of changes. You can enable or disable this in the file settings.

- Just in case, though, EuroBureau also sends you daily copies of any changed file by email. You can enable or disable this in your account settings.
- **Quitting**
 - EuroBureau exports to all standard and common word processor formats and your nightly backups are sent in word format (docx), so you can be confident that there's never a moment when you can't easily pack up and go to another AI-free, collaborative, secure, fully-featured, highly-integrated, self-publisher's office suite.

The above incomplete inventory is all most of us will probably need to decide at least to try EuroBureau. The rest of this document is essentially the same thing with greater detail and more screen shots.

Migrating *to* EuroBureau

Moving from Word or Google Docs or etc to EuroBureau is a matter of exporting to some standard, usually docx, and then uploading the result into EuroBureau using the upload button on your files console.

EuroBureau doesn't have all the same default fonts so, once migrated, you'll want to globally modify your styles if you used Arial or Helvetica, for which EuroBureau offers Inter or Roboto. In fact EuroBureau has open source knock-offs of all the popular typefaces and you can usually find what you want or something very comparable by going to the My Fonts section of your files console and entering your desired font into the meta search.

With docx format you're probably going to end up with a section per chapter. This is fine, but you need to know it, because when you set page sizes and margins they apply *only* to the *current* section. The smart kids remove all the sections (manually, I'm afraid) and globally apply page sizes and gutters (see 'gutters' in the point form section above) and then divide the document into, at most, two sections.

To remove sections, display invisibles by clicking the pilcrow symbol (¶ — did you know that was called a pilcrow?) and scroll through the document searching and destroying section breaks. They'll mostly be before each chapter.

If that all seems a little esoteric, let it go, and deal with it when and if it becomes a problem. The only thing you absolutely need to know when migrating to EuroBureau is you can import your book from docx format.

Page Numbers

This applies to almost all word processors except that for some reason it actually works consistently in EuroBureau.

- Page numbers can be applied to sections, meaning the pages that appear after you insert a section break.
 - They don't have to, though, so you have to tell EuroBureau how to treat page numbers starting on a new section if you want to start your page numbers after your front matter, meaning your title page, copyright bumf, dedication, and table of contents, and then page one of your story.
 - So, on the first page where you want page numbering to start, put your cursor in front of the first word and insert (from the insert menu) a section break of type Next Page. This will add a section break and now your story is in its own section.
 - Note, incidentally, that you can change a number of other characteristics at the section level, too, such as margins and even page size. Try to avoid that, unless you really want to do it, by setting page size and margins before adding any sections.
- Now go to the section in question and select Header & Footer->Edit Footer.
- Your menu has changed, now. First look for 'link to previous'. Uncheck this so that EuroBureau knows to treat this footer differently from that of the previous section.
- While here, have a look at how much space the headers and footers are consuming — it's probably too much. Tame that down a bit to, say, a quarter of an inch (imperial employed to gain publishing credibility).
- Now click on page numbers, select the position you like (top left, top middle, top, right, bottom left...) and, crucially select 'start on page 1'.
- Close all that down and you have page numbers starting on page one of your new section.
 - There's a good chance that this has added page numbers to the previous section, where you didn't want them, but you can to to any page in that section, edit the footer, and remove the page number and it won't effect the 'main' section.

Table of Contents

Once you’ve done all that business with page numbers, you can add a Table of Contents to your front matter (in fact you could have added and updated it at any time).

- Select a page, probably the one after the blank page after your title page (so that it appears on the right, if that matters to you).
- Go to the References tab.
- Select Table of Contents, and select the type you like (the choices at this writing are page numbers or hyperlinks).
- At any time you can put your cursor in the resulting box of contents to update the page numbers.
- You can also format your table of contents just like any other text, and you’re probably going to want to do that. It can still be updated after changing the formatting.

Fine Formatting

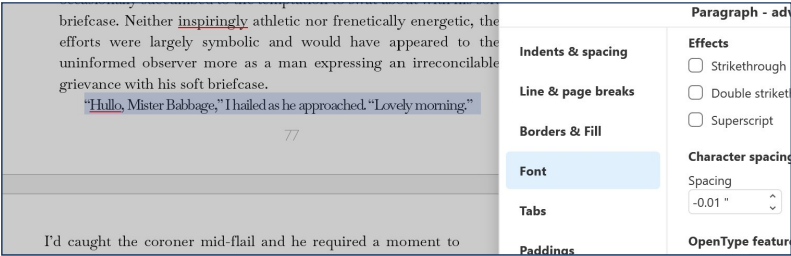
Few online editors offer character-spacing and line-spacing at all, never mind to the granularity available from EuroBureau, which competes with desktop word processors for fine formatting.

Nevertheless, when working with a long document you’ll want to keep any hints and nudges to a minimum and limited to widows, orphans, and balancing out chapter titles. As often as not it’s best to just mitigate a widow or orphan rather than try to eliminate it altogether.

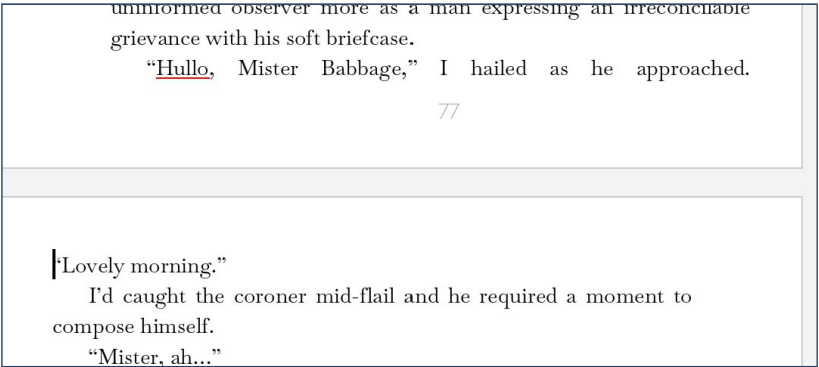
Take, for instance, this single word ‘morning’, orphaned on the next page...

grievance with his soft briefcase. <u>“Hullo,</u> Mister Babbage,” I hailed as he approached. “Lovely 77
morning.” I’d caught the coroner mid-flail and he required a moment to compose himself. “Mister, ah...”

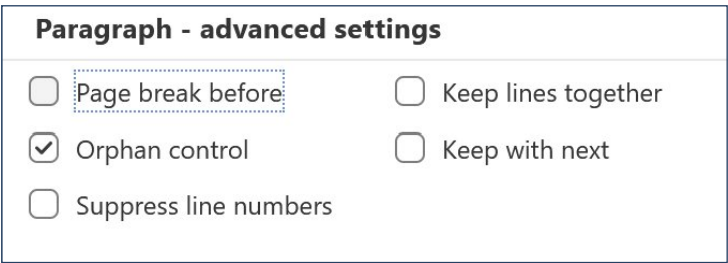
...which could be scrunched up onto the previous page by changing the character spacing, like this...



...but it’s probably better to just give your orphan a little company with a soft return (shift return) before ““Lovely’...



You might note, by the way, that EuroBureau offers extensive automatic widow and orphan control in the advanced paragraph settings:



It’s very nice of EuroBureau to offer that, of course, but think twice before using it — it typically and indiscriminately sends the entire line to the next page, creating an uneven baseline between facing pages. This is fine, if that’s what you want, but be sure you want it before turning on automated orphan control.

While we’re on the meaty subject of consistent baselines on facing pages, consider this when fiddling with paragraph options — it’s tempting to put space above or below paragraphs...

Line spacing

Multiple 1

Paragraph spacing

Before 0.03 " After 0 "

☐ Don't add interval between paragraphs of the same style

...but note that if you do, unless you happen to have an even number of paragraphs on facing pages, then the last lines won't be even and that looks subconsciously peculiar. Happily, the best solution for this is also the laziest — don't use paragraph spacing in the body of your book, instead distinguish between paragraphs by indenting the first line...

Indents

Left 0 " Right 0 "

Special First line 0.13 "

Export *for* POD

This is really what it's all about. All the finessing and fonts and gutters and widows and orphans is meant to get you to the point where you have a beautiful paperback laid out for print-on-demand and that, without making any changes, you can also use for further editing and generating the ebook.

The final checklist should probably include updating the table of contents and verifying that your gutter corresponds to that recommended by Amazon and Ingram Spark and Bookvault and whoever else might be printing your book.

Then from the file menu you choose 'Download As' and then select PDF/A, the preferred format which ensures, among other things, that the fonts are embedded in the document.

Lots and lots of self-publishers use multiple POD providers. I do too, and I use the same PDF for all of them. I find a nice universal gutter setting (.75" on the inside is loads for a book of two hundred to five hundred pages) and always start with Amazon because it's the quickest, cheapest, and easiest place to fail (second is Bookvault) so you'll know almost immediately if you've messed up, in which case you come back to EuroBureau, fix the document, and generate a new PDF.

As an aside, I use the same PDF for the cover for all POD providers, as well. I get the cover templates for the trim size and number of pages from all providers but mainly I base it on the Amazon template and use the others to make sure I've accommodated their bar code positioning. There are those who claim you can't do that, and I won't say they're wrong, so... moving on.

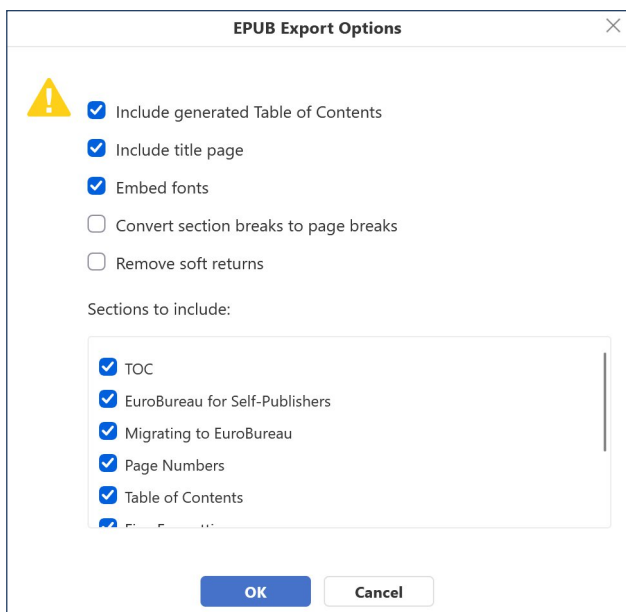
Other trim sizes

I only publish paperbacks in the one trim size and this grand unifying vision gets a little embarrassing when discussing, for instance, hard-covers. My strategy has been to ignore the problem and so far it's worked a treat, but I confess that for the moment EuroBureau is no better at generating multiple typeset trim sizes from the same document than is any other word-processor, online or otherwise.

Export *for* Ebook

EuroBureau exports an epub format optimised for self-publishing, and a big part of that optimisation is stripping out that which you did to make the book look nice as a paperback. There are no page numbers nor soft-returns nor hyphens nor widows and orphan control.

These are presented to you as options when you choose 'Download As' epub...



- Include generated Table of Contents
 - This will insert a list of hyperlinks at the beginning of your epub linking to all text styled Header 1 and Header 2 (typically, your chapters). It's a little old-school and readers are unlikely to use it in preference to the built-in dynamic table of contents offered by the device, so I uncheck this box.
- Include title page
 - This is an automatically generated title page. I uncheck this because the first page of my book is a nice title page with a subtitle and copyright.
- Embed fonts
 - I always check this because some ereaders support my custom font choices, as do some online previews. Mostly, though, you can leave this unchecked and it won't make a blind bit of difference.
 - Little caveat here — EuroBureau offers some nice ornamental typefaces — filagrees and tarabiscotti and fleurons that you can use to decorate chapter headings and the like, but they won't look nice on ereaders, which will display them as spurious letters. EuroBureau is reportedly working on a way to optionally convert these to images on export but for the moment you should probably avoid them.
- Convert section breaks to page breaks.

- I check this box although, really, I only ever have two sections, but they do like a little break.
- Remove soft returns
 - I always check this because my document is full of soft returns that I put in to make my paperback look pretty.
- Sections to include
 - I use this to deselect my table of contents (note that in order to be included in this list a section has to have a header on it).